

An Act

ENROLLED SENATE
BILL NO. 330

By: Murdock of the Senate

and

Moore of the House

An Act relating to the Oklahoma State University Veterinary Medicine Authority; defining terms; authorizing the Authority to conduct study on elk populations in this state; requiring a plan to be established by certain date; specifying parameters of study; requiring a management plan to be created at conclusion of study; allowing the Authority to coordinate with other agencies and experts; providing for codification; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

SUBJECT: Elk population study

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 4024 of Title 2, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. For the purposes of this section:

1. "Authority" means the Oklahoma State University Veterinary Medicine Authority;

2. "Management plan" means a document developed by the Oklahoma State University Veterinary Medicine Authority based on the findings of the study pursuant to this section that outlines the recommended actions for the conservation and management of elk populations in this state; and

3. "Study zone" means the Special Northwest Zone that encompasses all private lands in Woodward, Dewey, and Ellis counties, and a portion of Roger Mills County north of State Highways 33 and 47 to the north county line and west to the state border and east to the county line.

B. No later than November 1, 2026, the Oklahoma State University Veterinary Medicine Authority in cooperation with the Oklahoma State University College of Veterinary Medicine shall establish a plan and outline for a comprehensive study of the elk populations within the Special Northwest Zone. This study shall assess current population levels, trends, and habitat usage, and develop science-based management recommendations aimed at ensuring the long-term sustainability of elk populations and the health of the ecosystem. The study shall include, but not be limited to, the following program characteristics:

1. The current elk population size, distribution, and density within the study zone;

2. The health and genetic diversity of the elk population, including disease monitoring and signs of inbreeding, or other health concerns; and

3. The effectiveness and impact of current elk population management strategies, including hunting, predation control, and habitat management.

Recommendations from the study shall be assessed and compiled in a management plan for the conservation and management of elk populations within the study zone and shall be made available on the Authority's website.

C. The Authority may coordinate with other relevant state and federal agencies to effectuate the provisions of this section. Such coordination may include requests for temporary suspension and restrictions on elk hunting and harvesting while the study is being conducted.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the Senate the 26th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the 29th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____